

BUSLINK PRIVACY POLICY

Global Data Protection Charter, Privacy Controls & User Rights Framework

Document Reference:	BLK-PRV-2026-V2.1
Effective Date:	August 1, 2026
Issuing Office:	Office of the Data Protection Officer & Legal Affairs
Statutory Scope:	Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 & IT Act
Document Classification:	Public Security & Privacy Charter

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SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION AND COMMITMENT TO PRIVACY

1.1 Introduction

BusLink Network Private Limited ('BusLink', 'Company', 'We', 'Us', or 'Our') is committed to protecting the privacy, confidentiality, and security of the personal data shared with us by passengers, bus operators, website visitors, and mobile application users ('User', 'Data Principal', 'You'). This Privacy Policy ('Policy') explains how we collect, process, store, disclose, and protect your personal information when you access or use our online ticket reservation platform, mobile applications, customer support centers, and related transit services.

1.2 Statutory Compliance Framework

This Policy has been formulated in compliance with applicable data protection laws, including the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act), the Information Technology Act, 2000, the Information Technology (Reasonable Security Practices and Procedures and Sensitive Personal Data or Information) Rules, 2011, and international data privacy best practices.

1.3 Data Fiduciary Commitment

BusLink acts as the primary Data Fiduciary (Data Controller) regarding personal data collected directly for booking travel services, managing user accounts, and processing customer inquiries. We uphold principles of data minimization, purpose limitation, transparency, and robust security.

SECTION 2: SCOPE AND APPLICABILITY

2.1 Scope of the Policy

This Policy applies universally to all personal information collected across BusLink digital touchpoints and offline operational channels, including:

- The BusLink website (www.buslink.in) and regional portals.
- BusLink official mobile applications (iOS and Android).
- Passenger check-in counters and terminal station desks.
- B2B Operator Management Portals.
- Telephonic, email, and chat interactions with BusLink Customer Support.

2.2 Non-Applicability Disclaimer

This Policy does not apply to third-party services, external websites, or merchant services linked to or accessed through our platform that are operated by independent entities. We encourage you to review the privacy policies of third-party platforms before providing them with personal data.

SECTION 3: DEFINITIONS AND LEGAL CONSTRUCTS

For the purposes of this Privacy Policy, the following statutory terms shall have the meanings assigned below:

- **Personal Data:** Any data about an individual who is identifiable by or in relation to such data, including name, contact details, identification numbers, and location records.
- **Data Principal (User):** The individual to whom the personal data relates (e.g., passenger, account holder, bus operator representative).
- **Data Fiduciary:** Any person or entity who determines the purpose and means of processing personal data (BusLink).

- **Data Processor:** Any person or entity who processes personal data on behalf of a Data Fiduciary (e.g., cloud hosts, payment gateways).
- **Processing:** The automated or manual collection, recording, organization, structuring, storage, adaptation, retrieval, consultation, use, disclosure, or erasure of personal data.
- **Sensitive Personal Data:** Information relating to passwords, financial bank/card details, biometric data, and health parameters requiring heightened protection.
- **Consent:** Any freely given, specific, informed, unconditional, and unambiguous indication of the Data Principal's agreement to the processing of their personal data.

SECTION 4: CATEGORIES OF INFORMATION WE COLLECT

We collect several categories of personal data depending on the nature of your interaction with the BusLink platform:

4.1 Personal Identification Data

When reserving tickets or creating an account, we collect:

- Full Name, Age, Date of Birth, and Gender.
- Primary Phone Number and Email Address.
- Government Photo ID Details (Aadhaar, Passport, Driver's License, Voter ID) required for boarding verification.

4.2 Booking and Journey Information

- Origin city, destination city, travel date, seat/berth preferences, and boarding/drop waypoint selections.
- Passenger Name Record (PNR) details, e-Ticket history, and seat assignment records.
- Emergency contact person name and mobile number.

4.3 Financial and Payment Information

To complete ticket purchases, payment partners process payment credentials:

- Payment transaction IDs, payment method selected (UPI, Credit/Debit Card, Net Banking, Wallet), refund bank account details.

IMPORTANT PRIVACY NOTICE: BusLink NEVER stores raw credit card numbers, CVV codes, net banking passwords, or UPI PINs. All financial transactions are processed securely through RBI-licensed PCI-DSS compliant payment gateways.

4.4 Device and Technical Data

When you access BusLink via web or mobile apps, we automatically capture:

- IP Address, Device Brand & Model, Operating System version, Browser type, Unique Device Identifier (UDID), and Network Provider details.

4.5 Automated Logs, Location & Cookies

- Precise GPS Location Data (collected only with explicit user permission to locate nearby bus boarding terminals).
- Access timestamps, pages viewed, search queries, referral URLs, and app crash logs.

Summary Table: Categories of Collected Data & Purpose Matrix

Data Category	Specific Data Elements	Primary Operational Purpose
Personal Identity	Name, Age, Gender, Photo ID Details	Passenger verification & RTO manifests

Contact & Booking	Phone, Email, Route, Seat Number	Issuing e-Tickets & trip delay alerts
Financial Transaction	Encrypted Payment Ref ID, Refund Bank Details	Processing ticket payments & cancellations
Technical / Device	IP Address, UDID, Browser Type, Cookies	Platform security & fraud prevention

SECTION 5: PURPOSES OF DATA PROCESSING

BusLink processes personal data strictly for lawful, legitimate, and specified operational purposes:

1. Core Travel Service Delivery: Processing reservations, issuing digital e-Tickets, generating passenger trip manifests for RTO compliance, and delivering SMS/WhatsApp trip alerts.
2. Payment Processing & Refund Settlement: Facilitating secure ticket fare collection, processing promotional discounts, and disbursing customer cancellation refunds.
3. Operational Communication: Sending critical trip updates, boarding gate changes, highway delay notifications, and breakdown alerts.
4. Customer Support & Dispute Resolution: Resolving passenger complaints, processing lost property claims, and handling service refund appeals.
5. Safety, Security & Fraud Prevention: Verifying passenger identity at boarding, detecting fraudulent transactions, and preventing unauthorized account access.
6. Legal & Regulatory Compliance: Maintaining statutory travel manifests, tax accounting records, and responding to lawful court orders or government warrants.
7. Platform Improvement & Analytics: Conducting anonymized statistical research to enhance route planning, vehicle seating comfort, and user experience.

SECTION 6: INFORMATION SHARING AND DISCLOSURE

BusLink respects data confidentiality and restricts third-party sharing to essential operational requirements:

6.1 Sharing with Partner Bus Operators

To fulfill travel bookings, we share relevant passenger manifest details (Passenger Name, Age, Gender, Seat Number, Boarding Point, Contact Phone) with the specific bus operator operating your scheduled trip. Operators are contractually prohibited from using this data for marketing.

6.2 Sharing with Authorized Service Processors

We engage trusted third-party service providers who assist in operating our platform under strict confidentiality agreements:

- RBI-Authorized Payment Gateway Aggregators.
- Telecom SMS & WhatsApp Notification Service Providers.
- Cloud Infrastructure & Data Storage Providers.
- Customer Support Ticketing System Providers.

6.3 Legal & Law Enforcement Disclosures

We may disclose personal data to law enforcement agencies, courts, or regulatory authorities if required by law, subpoena, or government warrant to prevent crime or protect public safety.

6.4 Zero Sale of Personal Data

BusLink NEVER sells, rents, trades, or commercializes personal data to third-party advertisers or data brokers under any circumstances.

SECTION 7: COOKIES AND TRACKING TECHNOLOGIES

7.1 Use of Cookies

BusLink uses cookies, web beacons, and local browser storage to provide a seamless browsing experience, maintain user login sessions, and personalize search preferences.

7.2 Cookie Categories

- **Essential Cookies:** Required for basic site navigation, secure login, and session persistence during ticket checkout.
- **Functional Cookies:** Remember user preferences, default origin cities, language, and recent search history.
- **Performance & Analytics Cookies:** Collect anonymized traffic data to evaluate site load speed, popular routes, and feature usage.

7.3 User Cookie Controls

Users can manage or disable non-essential cookies through browser settings. Disabling essential cookies may impair core ticketing functionality.

SECTION 8: DATA SECURITY AND PROTECTION SAFEGUARDS

8.1 Technical Security Controls

BusLink implements robust technical safeguards to prevent unauthorized data access, loss, or alteration:

- **Data Encryption in Transit:** All data transmitted between user devices and BusLink servers is encrypted using Transport Layer Security (TLS 1.3 / SSL).
- **Data Encryption at Rest:** Sensitive databases, user account records, and stored credentials are encrypted using industry-standard AES-256 bit encryption.
- **Network Security:** Enterprise firewalls, Intrusion Detection Systems (IDS), and continuous vulnerability monitoring protect platform infrastructure.

8.2 Organizational Security Practices

- **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC):** Employee access to personal data is restricted strictly on a need-to-know operational basis.
- **Background Audits:** Mandatory NDA agreements and security training for all operations personnel.

8.3 Security Breach Management

In the event of a verified data breach impacting personal data, BusLink will notify affected users and the Data Protection Board within statutory timelines, detailing breach nature and remedial actions taken.

SECTION 9: DATA RETENTION AND DESTRUCTION POLICIES

9.1 Active Data Retention

BusLink retains personal data only as long as necessary to fulfill the operational purposes for which it was collected or to comply with statutory legal requirements.

9.2 Specific Retention Schedules

- Account Profiles: Retained for the duration of active account membership.
- Booking & Travel Records: Retained for 3 years post-journey to support customer queries, tax audits, and dispute resolution.
- Financial Transaction Logs: Retained for 7 years in compliance with statutory commercial tax laws.
- Temporary Search History & Cookies: Expired automatically after 30 to 90 days.

9.3 Data Destruction & Anonymization

Upon expiration of applicable retention periods or upon valid account deletion requests, personal data is securely deleted or permanently anonymized for statistical analysis.

Summary Table: Statutory Data Retention Schedule

Data Classification	Retention Period	Disposal Action
User Profile Data	Duration of active account relationship	Erasure upon account deletion
Travel & Booking Records	3 Years post-journey completion	Archival & anonymization
Financial & Tax Records	7 Years under statutory tax laws	Mandatory legal destruction after 7 yrs
Cookies & Search Logs	30 to 90 Days rolling window	Automated cache expiration

SECTION 10: USER RIGHTS AND PRIVACY CONTROLS

Under applicable data protection laws, Data Principals enjoy comprehensive rights regarding their personal information:

1. Right to Access & Portfolio Review: Request a summary of personal data held by BusLink, processing activities, and sharing history.
2. Right to Correction & Rectification: Request correction of inaccurate, incomplete, or out-of-date personal information.
3. Right to Erasure / Right to be Forgotten: Request deletion of your personal account and associated data, subject to legal retention obligations.
4. Right to Withdraw Consent: Withdraw previously granted processing consent at any time. Withdrawal does not affect lawful processing conducted prior to withdrawal.
5. Right to Nominate: Nominate an individual to exercise privacy rights in the event of death or incapacity.
6. Right to Grievance Redressal: Seek resolution of privacy complaints through BusLink’s designated Data Protection Officer (DPO).

SECTION 11: CHILDREN'S PRIVACY PROTECTION

11.1 Prohibition of Account Creation for Minors

BusLink services and digital applications are not directed to individuals under eighteen (18) years of age. Minors are strictly prohibited from creating independent BusLink user accounts.

11.2 Processing Child Passenger Information

Personal data relating to child passengers (under 18) is collected solely when provided by a parent or legal guardian for ticket reservation purposes. Such data is processed exclusively to issue e-Tickets and compile passenger trip manifests.

SECTION 12: THIRD-PARTY SERVICES AND LINKS

The BusLink platform may contain links to external third-party services (e.g., payment gateways, mapping providers, partner hotel booking portals). BusLink is not responsible for the privacy practices, content, or security standards of third-party platforms. We advise users to review the privacy notices of external services upon leaving BusLink.

SECTION 13: INTERNATIONAL DATA TRANSFERS

13.1 Primary Data Localization

All core passenger databases, booking records, and financial logs are primary-hosted and processed within secure, tier-4 certified data centers located within the territory of India.

13.2 Cross-Border Transfers

If international data transfer becomes necessary for global roaming assistance or international payment settlement, BusLink ensures transfers strictly comply with legal standards and standard contractual clauses guaranteeing equivalent data protection.

SECTION 14: POLICY UPDATES AND NOTIFICATIONS

BusLink reserves the right to modify this Privacy Policy to reflect changes in legal requirements, technology, or business operations. In the event of material policy changes, we will notify registered users via email, SMS, or prominent in-app banner notifications at least 30 days prior to implementation.

SECTION 15: CONTACT INFORMATION AND GRIEVANCE OFFICER

For questions, privacy rights requests, or formal data protection grievances, users may contact the BusLink Data Protection Office:

- Data Protection Officer (DPO): Mr. Aniket Sharma
- Designation: Chief Information Security Officer & DPO
- Office Address: BusLink Towers, Floor 6, Cyber City, Gurugram, HR – 122002, India
- Dedicated Privacy Email: dpo@buslink.in | privacy@buslink.in
- Privacy Helpline: 1800-555-PRIVACY (Mon-Fri, 09:00 AM – 06:00 PM IST)

SECTION 16: FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQS)

Q1: What personal data does BusLink collect when I book a ticket?

A: We collect your name, age, gender, phone number, email ID, travel route, seat preference, and photo ID details for boarding.

Q2: Does BusLink store my credit card or debit card numbers?

A: No! BusLink never stores credit/debit card numbers or PINs. Payments are processed securely via PCI-DSS compliant RBI-licensed gateways.

Q3: Why is my mobile number mandatory for ticket booking?

A: Your mobile number is required to send your e-Ticket PNR, boarding location details, and critical delay notifications via SMS/WhatsApp.

Q4: Is my personal information shared with the bus operator?

A: Yes, basic passenger details (Name, Age, Gender, Seat Number, Phone) are shared with the operating bus company to prepare the mandatory passenger manifest.

Q5: Can bus operators use my phone number for marketing calls?

A: No! Bus operators are contractually forbidden from using passenger contact details for marketing or unauthorized purposes.

Q6: How long does BusLink retain my booking history?

A: Travel records are retained for 3 years to handle customer support, tax auditing, and legal compliance.

Q7: Can I delete my BusLink user account and personal data?

A: Yes, you can submit an account deletion request under your profile settings or by emailing dpo@buslink.in.

Q8: What happens to my data after I delete my account?

A: Your profile data is erased within 30 days, except financial records retained for statutory tax audit periods.

Q9: Does BusLink track my live GPS location continuously?

A: GPS location is captured only when you explicitly grant app permission to find nearby boarding terminals.

Q10: Are child passenger details protected?

A: Yes, child data (under 18) is collected strictly from parents/guardians solely for ticket issuance and manifests.

Q11: How does BusLink encrypt my password?

A: Passwords are encrypted using industry-standard irreversible cryptographic hashing algorithms.

Q12: Does BusLink sell personal data to third-party advertising companies?

A: Never! BusLink has a strict policy against selling, renting, or trading user data.

Q13: What are essential cookies on the website?

A: Essential cookies maintain your active login session and seat selection during checkout.

Q14: Can I opt-out of promotional marketing SMS and emails?

A: Yes, click the 'Unsubscribe' link in emails or manage communication preferences under account settings.

Q15: Will I still receive SMS alerts if I unsubscribe from marketing?

A: Yes, operational SMS alerts (PNR details, delay notifications, refund status) will still be sent.

Q16: How do I report a suspected privacy breach or unauthorized login?

A: Report immediately to dpo@buslink.in or call our 24/7 helpline at 1800-555-PRIVACY.

Q17: Is my photo ID information stored permanently?

A: Photo ID details are verified for boarding manifests and encrypted securely in access-restricted systems.

Q18: Where is my data physically hosted?

A: Primary data is hosted within secure, certified tier-4 data centers located inside India.

Q19: What is the role of the Data Protection Officer (DPO)?

A: The DPO oversees data privacy compliance, handles user rights requests, and resolves privacy grievances.

Q20: How soon will BusLink respond to a data correction request?

A: Data correction requests are processed within 7 business days of verification.

Q21: Does BusLink record customer support phone calls?

A: Calls may be recorded for quality auditing and staff training purposes, with prior automated disclosure.

Q22: What happens if BusLink updates its Privacy Policy?

A: Registered users receive an email/SMS notification at least 30 days prior to material updates.

Q23: Can I book a ticket for a friend using my account?

A: Yes, you can enter the passenger's details during booking. Their info is used solely for that journey's manifest.

Q24: Why does the app request permission to access camera/photos?

A: Camera access is requested only if you choose to scan payment QR codes or upload profile photos.

Q25: Can I request a copy of all data BusLink holds about me?

A: Yes, submit a Data Access Request to dpo@buslink.in to receive your personal data export.

Q26: What is the Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP)?

A: The Indian law regulating personal data processing, guaranteeing data principal rights and fiduciary duties.

Q27: Does BusLink use automated decision-making or profiling for pricing?

A: Dynamic pricing is based on general route demand and seat fill factors, not personal user profiling.

Q28: Are passenger manifests shared with highway police?

A: Manifests are presented to authorized RTO or police officials during routine highway safety checks.

Q29: Can I change my registered email address?

A: Yes, update your email address in account profile settings following OTP verification.

Q30: What happens if I input an incorrect phone number during guest booking?

A: Contact Customer Support with your PNR and transaction reference to update contact details.

Q31: Are credit card details saved if I choose 'Save Card' option?

A: Card tokens are saved by RBI-certified payment aggregators using tokenization, not stored by BusLink.

Q32: How are refund transaction logs protected?

A: Refund records are encrypted and restricted to authorized finance reconciliation personnel.

Q33: Does BusLink share data with social media networks?

A: Data is shared only if you explicitly choose to log in via social authentication providers.

Q34: How are cookies cleared from my device?

A: Clear cookies via your web browser security settings or mobile app cache options.

Q35: What happens to my data if BusLink undergoes a corporate merger?

A: Your data remains protected under this Policy, and you will be notified of any ownership transfer.

Q36: Are emergency contact details shared with anyone?

A: Emergency contact details are accessed solely by crew during medical or highway accidents.

Q37: Can I withdraw consent for data processing?

A: Yes, you can withdraw consent anytime, though it may prevent further booking services.

Q38: How does BusLink prevent data leakages?

A: Through enterprise firewalls, data encryption, penetration testing, and 24/7 security monitoring.

Q39: Is my booking search history private?

A: Recent searches are stored locally on your device for user convenience and cleared periodically.

Q40: Can I lodge a complaint with government privacy authorities?

A: Yes, if unsatisfied with our DPO's resolution, you may approach the Data Protection Board of India.

Q41: Does BusLink track me across other websites?

A: BusLink does not track your online activity outside our official platform domains.

Q42: What security standard does BusLink follow?

A: We adhere to ISO/IEC 27001 standards and PCI-DSS compliance frameworks.

Q43: Are co-passengers able to see my personal phone number?

A: No, passenger contact details are completely private and never visible to other travelers.

Q44: How are paper manifests disposed of by conductors after trips?

A: Physical manifest sheets are submitted to station depots and shredded securely after verification.

Q45: Who can I contact for urgent privacy questions?

A: Email our Data Protection Officer directly at dpo@buslink.in.

SECTION 17: LEGAL AND PRIVACY GLOSSARY

- Data Principal: The individual natural person to whom personal data relates (the user).
- Data Fiduciary: The legal entity determining the purpose and means of personal data processing (BusLink).
- Data Processor: An entity processing personal data on behalf of the Data Fiduciary under contract.
- Consent: Explicit, informed, and unambiguous agreement granted by a Data Principal for data processing.
- Encryption: The mathematical encoding of data into unreadable ciphertext to prevent unauthorized access.
- Anonymization: The irreversible process of removing personal identifiers so data cannot link to an individual.
- Cookie: A small text file stored on a user's device by web browsers to retain session preferences.
- PNR (Passenger Name Record): A unique 10-character code representing a specific ticket reservation.
- DPO (Data Protection Officer): The designated officer responsible for privacy compliance and grievance resolution.

SECTION 18: DOCUMENT REVISION HISTORY

This Privacy Policy undergoes formal periodic reviews. Below is the document control log:

Document Revision History Table

Version	Effective Date	Author / Office	Summary of Revisions
1.0	15-Jan-2024	Legal & Compliance Dept	Initial Privacy Policy Release
2.0	10-Jan-2025	Office of DPO	Updated for GDPR & IT Act Rules
2.1	01-Aug-2026	Data Protection Office	DPDP Act 2023 Alignment & 45 FAQs

